

Design your home with WikiHouse

A London-based firm has developed an open source house design and construction kit called WikiHouse in collaboration with Momentum Engineering and Espians. The designers have applied tools for open source design, Open Hardware, which they had earlier used in their open source furniture. The WikiHouse website illustrates easy steps on how to design, download and construct your own house. One can download designs of houses and components from the design community library and use a customised function in Google Sketchup to generate CNC cutting patterns. The illustrations could then be sent to the CNC cutter for fabrication from plywood.



US spy agency open sources Accumulo

The National Security Agency, the top US electronic intelligence service, is open sourcing Accumulo—a distributed 'NoSQL' database that is based on Google's proprietary BigTable platform. NSA has been developing the platform internally since 2008. The agency has submitted the project to the Apache Foundation for incubation.

BackBox Linux 2 released

The BackBox Linux 2 penetration distribution system is out, with an all-new look, feel and performance! It consists of the 2.6.38 Linux kernel and version 4.8.0 of the Xfce desktop environment, and is based on Ubuntu 11.04 'Natty Narwhal'. The system has three new security audit sections: Vulnerability Assessment, Forensic Analysis and VoIP Analysis. The modifications include updated hacking tools, an improved system menu and various bug fixes. Firefox 6.0.1, Thunderbird 3.1.13, version 2.7.11 of the Pidgin IM client, AbiWord and version 2.13 of the Transmission BitTorrent client have been included in its packages.



Ubuntu 11.10 beta arrives

Release of Ubuntu 11.10, the beta version of Canonical's free and open source Linux distribution, has been announced. The new release offers a good feel of what Ubuntu 11.10 'Oneiric Ocelot' will be like. It features a smaller DVD image and is reduced to a manageable size of 1.5 GB. A set of images called Ubuntu Core has also been added in the beta version.



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